



By Brinda Bose

► In 2004, the notorious MMS sex scandal involving two teenaged students of a prestigious school in Delhi catapulted questions about liberated sexualities, cyber technologies, privacy, censorship and voyeurism into a noisy, though unresolved, public debate.

► In 2009, Anurag Kashyap directed an intelligently-contemporised fresh new take on the venerated Devdas' tale of love, longing and loss, in which the story of Dev D's city-squeeze Leni/Chanda (a hormonally hyperactive schoolgirl by day and an expensive call-girl by night) is clearly inspired by the Capital's schoolchildren's MMS-malfunction disaster.

► In 2009, the television reality show Sach Ka Saamna, in which contestants took a lie-detector test before facing 21 embarrassing questions about the most intimate aspects of their lives, was launched to high TVRs but was immediately engulfed in controversy for promoting voyeurism.

► In 2010, critically acclaimed filmmaker Dibakar Banerjee will complete his new experimental film in which, he says, "the central idea or mood is pure voyeurism. We will be taking the camera from the bedroom, to the sewer, canal, bathroom, bus, picnic spot, hanging from a fan in a room, even hidden in a handbag, in a make-up van or restaurant. The actors will wield the camera".

Voyeurism and exhibitionism have found a happy hunting ground in India, it appears. A chimeral anxiety, however, shadows the liberatory, celebratory aura emanating from this phantasma of sexual excess and success. It is, in fact, exactly at this nexus that 21st century India is caught and stumped: even as we race at breakneck speed towards ever-more-sophisticated, increasingly innovative media

44 PER CENT RESPONDENTS BETWEEN THE AGE GROUP OF 41 AND 50 HAVE ADMITTED TO HAVING VIDEO-RECORDED OR MAKING MMS OF THEMSELVES WHILE HAVING SEX.

REEL PLAYING

Getting oneself videographed is the new seduction mantra for the techno-savvy Indians, with more than 40 per cent respondents saying they have video-recorded their love-making sessions.

43

Yes

Male 44,
Female 41

57

No

Male 56,
Female 59

Rest don't know/can't say.
All figures in per cent.

For 453 respondents of the total 5,371 who had fantasised about making an MMS during sex. All figures in per cent.

Have you ever shared the recorded video or MMS with anyone?

YES 75

Male 81, Female 56

NO 23

Male 18, Female 40

For 196 respondents of the total 5,371 who had made MMS during sex. Rest don't know/can't say. All figures in per cent.

In Mumbai, of those who have fantasised about sex MMSes, 88 per cent men have video-recorded themselves while having sex and 92 per cent have admitted to sharing it with others. Delhi women seem to be bolder with 67 per cent admitting to having made such an MMS. More single women (54 per cent) have made an MMS compared to their male counterparts (36 per cent).